Advanced Punctuation (Set B)

Year 4 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Worked Example: Explain the difference between how a dash and a pair of brackets are used to add extra information, using one example sentence for each.

Answer: Both add extra, removable information. A dash — like this — feels more dramatic/informal, e.g. 'The cake — my favourite — was gone.' Brackets feel more formal/neutral, e.g. 'The cake (my favourite) was gone.'

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The wind dropped. The sea grew calm.'
2. Add a colon to introduce the list: 'Pack these items a jumper a hat and gloves.'
3. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech? A) Sam said, I am tired. B) Sam said, "I am tired." C) Sam said "I am tired" D) "Sam said I am tired." E) Sam said: I am tired.
4. Add brackets to insert this extra detail: 'My teacher who studied in France speaks fluent French.'
5. Underline the correct use of a dash in: 'The journey — though long — was enjoyable.'
6. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'Is dinner ready asked Mia'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a colon to introduce a list? A) He packed: trainers, shorts and a towel. B) He packed trainers: shorts and a towel. C) He needed three things: focus, time and energy. D) He needed: three things. E) The winners were: Jo, Alex and Sam.
8. Which punctuation mark correctly joins these two related sentences: 'She was thrilled ___ she had won first prize.'? A) comma B) colon C) semicolon D) dash E) full stop with no change
9. Add speech marks to: Wait for me! called Noah.
10. Explain what a colon does before a list, using the sentence: 'Bring the following: a book, a pen and a ruler.'
11. Which sentence correctly uses a semicolon to join two related main clauses? A) The power failed; because of the lightning. B) The power failed, the lightning was fierce. C) The power failed; the lightning was fierce. D) The power failed: the lightning was fierce. E) The power failed the lightning was fierce.
12. Punctuate this sentence with brackets around the extra information: 'The library which opens at ten is free to join.'
13. Write a short sentence of direct speech with the reporting clause BEFORE the speech, punctuated correctly.
14. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly punctuate a dash used to add an afterthought? A) The race was close — until the last lap. B) The race was close, until the last lap —. C) The race was close — until the last lap. D) The — race was close until the last lap. E) The match ended in a tie — a fair result.
15. Explain why 'She said "finally"' is missing a capital letter and a full stop, and correct it.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. Join these two related sentences using a semicolon: 'The test was tricky. Most students still did well.'
2. Add a colon to this sentence: 'There was only one reason he was smiling he had passed.'
3. Which sentence correctly punctuates a piece of direct speech split by a reporting clause? A) "I believe," said Omar, "we can win." B) "I believe" said Omar "we can win." C) "I believe, said Omar, we can win." D) I believe, said Omar, "we can win." E) "I believe said Omar we can win."

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4. Insert dashes to add this extra comment: 'The weather report and it is usually accurate predicted sunshine.'

5. Explain the difference between using a comma and using a semicolon to join two main clauses, with an example of each.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use brackets for extra (removable) information? A) The tower (built in 1890) still stands. B) The tower built in 1890 (still stands.) C) The recipe (serves six) takes two hours. D) (The recipe serves six) takes two hours. E) Our coach (Mrs Lane) is very encouraging.

7. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'I cannot believe it he gasped we actually won'

8. Which punctuation mark best replaces the gap: 'The decision was final ___ the appeal was rejected.'? A) comma B) colon C) apostrophe D) exclamation mark E) hyphen

9. Explain when you would choose a dash rather than a colon to introduce extra information, giving one example of each.

10. Rewrite this sentence using a semicolon instead of 'and': 'The choir practised daily, and they deserved to win.'

11. Which sentence correctly punctuates a question within direct speech? A) He asked, "Are we lost?" B) He asked "Are we lost"? C) He asked, "Are we lost"? D) He asked: "Are we lost?" E) He asked, Are we lost?

12. Add a colon to introduce an explanation in: 'There was a simple reason for the delay the train broke down.'

13. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly use a semicolon rather than a comma to join two independent clauses? A) He likes football; she prefers tennis. B) He likes football, she prefers tennis. C) It was late; we still finished the walk. D) It was late, we still finished the walk. E) The shop opened late; customers waited outside.

14. Write one sentence that correctly uses a colon to introduce a single dramatic statement (not a list).

15. Explain why brackets, dashes and commas can all sometimes be used to mark off the same piece of extra information, giving one sentence punctuated three different ways.

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Correct this sentence: 'Its time to go, the bus is waiting.'

2. Which sentence correctly punctuates the extra information in: 'The teacup, the one Gran gave us, is cracked.'? A) The teacup the one Gran gave us is cracked. B) The teacup (the one Gran gave us) is cracked. C) The teacup; the one Gran gave us; is cracked. D) The teacup: the one Gran gave us is cracked. E) The teacup, the one Gran gave us is cracked

3. Finish punctuating this sentence correctly: 'she asked are we nearly there'

4. Punctuate this sentence correctly, choosing the mark that introduces an explanation: 'he had one wish to pass the test'

5. Correct the punctuation error in: 'The library was silent, suddenly the fire alarm rang.'

6. Read: 'The rain stopped and the sun came out.' (a) Join these two ideas with a semicolon instead of 'and'. (b) Explain in one sentence why a semicolon works here.

7. Read: 'he shouted stop right there' (a) Add speech marks and correct capitalisation. (b) Add the exclamation mark in the correct place.

8. Which sentence correctly uses a colon before a list? A) He needed: a pen and paper. B) He needed two things: a pen and paper. C) He needed two things, a pen and paper: D) He needed a pen: and paper. E) He needed two things: a pen, and, paper.

9. Select ALL the sentences below that correctly join 'The match restarted' and 'The rain had stopped' using correct punctuation. A) The match restarted; the rain had stopped. B) The match restarted, the rain had stopped. C) The match restarted: the rain had stopped. D) The match restarted the rain had stopped. E) The match restarted — the rain had stopped.

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10. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly use a pair of dashes to add extra information? A) The cake — a birthday gift — was delicious. B) The cake a birthday gift — was delicious. C) Our coach — Mr Lee — is very strict. D) Our coach Mr Lee — is very strict —. E) The match — despite the rain — went ahead.

11. Read: 'The team was ready, the whistle blew and the game began.' (a) Find and correct the one punctuation error. (b) Explain what kind of error it was.

12. Read this short exchange: are you ready asked Leo yes I am replied Nina (a) Punctuate Leo's question correctly. (b) Punctuate Nina's reply correctly.

13. Read: 'The cave was pitch dark everyone felt uneasy.' (a) Add the correct punctuation to join these two ideas. (b) Explain why a comma alone would be wrong here.

14. Which sentence correctly combines brackets AND a colon in the same sentence? A) The shop (now closed) sold one thing: postcards. B) The shop now closed sold one thing postcards. C) The shop (now closed sold one thing): postcards. D) The shop, now closed: sold one thing (postcards). E) The shop (now closed) sold one thing, postcards:

15. Read this passage: 'he said we should hurry up the gates close at six' (a) Add speech marks around the spoken words. (b) Add the missing punctuation mark inside the speech marks.

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